

Miner Diamond Fortunes Rise

The University of Texas at El Paso baseball team has long been the doormat of the Western Athletic Conference. But UTEP's fortunes appear to be on the rise as Coach Andy Cohen's team has already matched its 1975 win total.

The Miners are 11-5-1 with 36 games remaining, including a doubleheader with Western New Mexico at noon Wednesday on the UTEP diamond.

Several of the baseball players feel that recognition of their efforts should be known.

"Heck, if we sweep both games tomorrow," says pitcher Dave Jannusch, "we'll already have more victories than the UTEP football and basketball teams combined."

Bruce Dameworth (2-0) will be on the mound for UTEP in the opener while Mike Iaeger is expected to make his first start ever for the Miners in the nightcap.

Iaeger, a graduate of Andress High School, recently joined the UTEP squad and went 1½ innings, allowing one earned run, in his first appearance Monday.

"After being off from playing baseball so long, it's going to take time for me to get back in shape," admitted Iaeger. "It'll be interesting to see how I do."

Western New Mexico is playing its season opener.